ZCAS UNIVERSITY

SCHOOL OF COMPUTING, TECHNOLOGY & APPLIED SCIENCES

CIT3252 KNOWLEDGE MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

DEFERED EXAMINATION

DATE: 19TH DECEMBER 2024

TIME: 14:00 – 17:00 HOURS

TIME ALLOWED: WRITING – THREE HOURS: READING – 5 MINUTES

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Section A: this question is **compulsory** and must be attempted.
2. Sections B: Answer **THREE (3)** questions from this section.
3. This examination paper carries a total of **100 marks**.
4. Candidates must **not turn this page** until the invigilator tells them to do so.

SECTION A: Question 1 is compulsory and must be attempted

Question 1

Case Study:

Bright Futures University is a large, multi-disciplinary institution with a strong focus on research and innovation. Despite its reputation, the university has faced challenges in fostering collaboration among its academic departments and transferring research insights to practical applications. Faculty members often work in silos, limiting the exchange of ideas and knowledge across disciplines. Furthermore, valuable research findings and innovative teaching methods remain underutilized due to a lack of structured knowledge-sharing practices.

To address these issues, the university has decided to implement a knowledge management strategy centred on the SECI model (Socialization, Externalization, Combination, Internalization). The goal is to:

1. Facilitate the sharing of tacit knowledge through collaboration among researchers and teaching staff.
2. Convert research insights and teaching innovations into explicit knowledge for broader dissemination.
3. Combine knowledge across disciplines to foster interdisciplinary research and develop innovative teaching programmes.
4. Internalize best practices and research findings into teaching and administrative processes to enhance the quality of education and institutional efficiency.

a) Explain how each phase of the SECI model (Socialization, Externalization, Combination, Internalization) can address the challenges at Bright Futures University. Provide specific examples of how these phases can be implemented in academic and research activities. **(20 Marks)**

b) Identify and discuss two factors that could hinder the successful application of the SECI model in an academic setting, such as organizational culture or resource constraints. Propose tailored solutions to address these factors. **(10 Marks)**

c) Suggest two practical steps Bright Futures University can take to ensure the SECI model is effectively implemented and sustained in its operations. Explain how these steps would support continuous knowledge sharing and innovation. **(10 Marks)**

[Total: 40 Marks]

SECTION B: Attempt any THREE questions in this section

Question 2

a) Explain the concept of Organisational Memory and discuss its significance in ensuring long-term knowledge retention within an organisation. **(10 Marks)**

b) Describe two methods an organisation could use to enhance its organisational memory. Provide an example for each method in the context of a technology company.

(10 Marks)

[Total: 20 Marks]

Question 3

a) Distinguish Tacit and Explicit Knowledge within an organisational context. **(8 Marks)**

b) Describe the process of codification and discuss how it transforms tacit knowledge into explicit knowledge. **(8 Marks)**

c) Explain one advantage and one limitation of codifying tacit knowledge within an organisation. **(4 Marks)**

[Total: 20 Marks]

Question 4

a) Discuss the role of Communities of Practice (CoPs) in fostering knowledge sharing within organisations. **(8 Marks)**

b) Explain two challenges associated with managing CoPs and suggest strategies for addressing each challenge. **(8 Marks)**

c) Provide an example of how CoPs can enhance innovation in a technology company. **(4 Marks)**

[Total: 20 Marks]

Question 5

a) Discuss the role of leadership in driving successful knowledge management initiatives within an organization. Provide examples of leadership styles that are conducive to KM. **(8 Marks)**

b) Explain the concept of knowledge workers and describe how organizations can attract, develop, and retain them to sustain a competitive advantage. **(8 Marks)**

c) Identify one challenge that organizations face in managing a knowledge worker-centric workforce and suggest a solution to address it. **(4 Marks)**

[Total: 20 Marks]

END OF EXAMINATION